the subject of whether, in general, pharmaceutical prices should be regulated, or their advertisement forbidden. Nor can it be dispositive that a commercial advertisement is noneditorial, and merely reports a fact. Purely factual matter of public interest may claim protection. *Bigelow* v. *Virginia,* 421 U. S., at 822; *Thornhill* v. *Alabama,* 310 U. S. 88, 102 (1940).

Our question is whether speech which does "no more than propose a commercial transaction," *Pittsburgh Press Co.* v. *Human Relations Comm'n,* 413 U. S., at 385, is so removed from any "exposition of ideas," *Chaplinsky* v. *New Hampshire,* 315 U. S. 568, 572 (1942), and from " 'truth, science, morality, and arts in general, in its diffusion of liberal sentiments on the administration of Government,' " *Roth* v. *United States,* 354 U. S. 476, 484 (1957), that it lacks all protection. Our answer is that it is not.

Focusing first on the individual parties to the transaction that is proposed in the commercial advertisement, we may assume that the advertiser's interest is a purely economic one. That hardly disqualifies him from protection under the First Amendment. The interests of the contestants in a labor dispute are primarily economic, but it has long been settled that both the employee and the employer are protected by the First Amendment when they express themselves on the merits of the dispute in order to influence its outcome. See, *e. g., NLRB* v. *Gissel Packing Co.,* 395 U. S. 575, 617–618 (1969); *NLRB* v. *Virginia Electric & Power Co.,* 314 U. S. 469, 477 (1941); *AFL* v. *Swing,* 312 U. S. 321, 325–326 (1941); *Thornhill* v. *Alabama,* 310 U. S., at 102. We know of no requirement that, in order to avail themselves of First Amendment protection, the parties to a labor dispute need address themselves to the merits of unionism in general